Ans. (a) : International trade was in vogue during the Gupta period. Foreign trade was possible through the ports. The major ports of the Gupta period were Ghantashala, Kadura, Chaul, Male, Tamralipti Sopara Arikamedu Kalyan, Bhrigukachchha etc. Through these port, the national and international trade were regulated.

9. With reference to the scholars/litterateurs of ancient India, consider the following statements:

1. Panini is associated with Pushyamitra Shunga
2. Amarasimha is associated with Harshavardhana
3. Kalidasa is associated with Chandra Gupta-II

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : Panini (4th century BCE or 6th to 5 th century BCE) was an ancient Sanskrit grammarian and a revered scholar in ancient India. Panini likely lived in the northwest Indian subcontinent during the Mahajanapada era. Hence statement 1 is not correct.

He is said to have been born in shalatula of ancient Gandhara, a small town at the junction of the Indus and Kabul rivers, Pakistan. Panini is known for his text Ashtadhyayi, a Sutra-style treatise in sanskrit grammar, 3959 "verses" or rules on linguistics syntax and semantics with "eight chapters", which is the foundational text of the Vyakarana branch of the Vedanga. Ashtadhyayi is admired for its simplicity and its rigorous and consistent use of meta language. Sutras are like mathematical formulas. So a lot of information can be given using a few words.

Pushyamitra Sunga (185 BC to 151 BC) was the founder and first ruler of the Shunga Empire in East India. He was follower of Hinduism. Pushyamitra was originally a Senapati "General" of the Maurya Empire. In 185 BCE he assassinated the last Mauryan Emperor, Brihadratha Maurya and proclaimed himself emperor.

Chandragupta II also called Vikramaditya, powerful Emperor (reigned 380 CE to 415 CE) of Northern India. During his regin art, architecture and sculpture flourished and the cultural development of ancient India reached its Golden period. He was known for his deep interest in art and culture and nine gems or Navratna adorned his court.

The group (Team of Navratna) comprised of–

1. Kalidasa, 2. Vetala Bhatta, 3. Varahamihira,
4. Varruchi, 5. Amarasimha, 6. Dhanvantari,
7. Kshanpanak, 8. Shanku, 9. Ghatakarpura

Kalidasa was a famous Sanskrit writer and poet in the court of Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya). He was the author of three famous plays–

1. Abhijnanasakuntalam, 2. Malavikagnimitram,
3. Kumarasambhava.

Amarasimha was one of the nine gems in the court of Vikramaditya of Gupta era. Notably known for his famous Sanskrit thesaurus Amarakosha. It is also known as Namalinganushasanam.

10. With reference to the history of India, the terms "kulyavapa" and "dronavapa" denote–

(a) measurement of land
(b) coins of different monetary value
(c) classifications of urban land
(d) religious rituals

Ans. (a) : Gupta Economy: The agricultural crops constituted the main resources that the society produced and the major part of the state's revenues came from agriculture. Various types of land are mentioned in the inscriptions, land under cultivation was usually called Kshetra, Khila was the uncultivate land, Aprahata was the jungle or forest land, Gopata Sarah was the pasture and Vasti was the habitable land. Different land measures were known in different regions such as Nivartana, Kulyavapa and Dronavapa are used. In the inscription of Bengal, terms like Kulyavapa and Dronavapa are used.

11. With reference to the history of India, consider the following pairs:

1. Aurang – In-charge of treasury of the state
2. Banian – Indian agent of the East India Company
3. Mirasidar – Designated revenue payer to the State

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b) : Aurang was a Persian term for a warehouse where goods are collected before being sold, also refers to a workshop for finised good. Thus, pair (1) is not correct.

Banians (banias) were the agents of the company merchants by whom the English gentlemen in general conduct all their business. The banian brought his skill and his capital to the partnership; and the European contributed his privileges. Thus, pair (2) is correct. mirasidar in Urdu means hereditary landowner, co-proprietor. In Persian Miras is an inheritance estate. He was also a revenue payer to the state. Thus pair (3) is correct.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

12. Wellesley established the Fort William College at Calcutta because–

(a) he was asked by the Board of Directors at London to do so
(b) he wanted to revive interest in oriental learning in India
(c) he wanted to provide William Carey and his associates with employment
(d) he wanted to train British civilians for administrative purpose in India

Ans. (d) : Fort William College was founded by Lord Richard Wellesley in Calcutta on the Eastern bank of the Hooghly River on 10th July, 1800. The British territories in India had expanded greatly and there was an urgent need for trained men who could communicate in the local languages and understand the country and the people. The objective to train these officials, the Fort William College was established which aim was to create Civil Servants who were familiar with Indian languages, history, culture and local laws. Eventually which could bring in organised administration throughly.

MODERN HISTORY

• Disintegration of Mughal Empire & Advent of European Countries

13. In the context of Indian history, the Rakhmabai case of 1884 revolved around–

1. women's right to gain education
2. age of consent
3. restitution of conjugal rights

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b) : Rukhmabai (1864-1955) was the first practising female doctor in Colonial India. Rukhmabai also made her mark in history due to the legal case she was involved in, which contributed to the enactment of the age of Consent Act, 1891. She was married off at the young age of eleven, while her husband, Dadaji Bhikaji, was nineteen years old. He later got in touch with her. She refused to go, continued to live with her stepfather and pursued her education, going against the norms of society. In 1885, after 12 years of marriage, Bhikaji Sought restitution of conjugal rights. The British precedent could not be implied in this case, as British laws were meant to be applied in the case of consenting adult. Hence, Justice Pinhey found this limitation in British law and found no previous cases of such nature in Hindu law. Hence his judgement on the case stated that Rukhmabai had been wed as an innocent child, had no say in the matter and now couldn't be forced. Subsequently, after numerous hearings, the marriage was affirmed, Rukhmabai wrote to Queen Victoria. The Queen overruled the Court's verdict and dissolved the marriage. The ripples that the case created led to the influence on the passage of the Age of Consent Act, 1891, child marriage illegal across the British Empire.

• Social, Cultural Awakening, Lower Caste, Trade Unions and Peasant Movement

14. With reference to the history of India, "Ulgulan" or the Great Tumult is the description of which of the following events?

(a) The Revolt of 1857
(b) The Mappila Rebellion of 1921
(c) The Indigo Revolt of 1859-60
(d) Birsa Munda's Revolt of 1899-1900

Ans. (d) : Munda Rebellion is one of the prominent 19th century tribal rebellions in the subcontinent. Birsa Munda led this movement in the region South of Ranchi in 1899-1900. The 'Ulgulan' meaning 'Great Tumult' sought to establish Munda Raj and Independence.

15. Indigo cultivation in India declined by the beginning of the 20th century because of–

(a) peasant resistance to the oppressive conduct of planters
(b) its unprofitability in the world market because of new inventions
(c) national leader's opposition to the cultivation of indigo
(d) Government control over the planters

Ans. (b) : Because of its high value as a trading commodity, indigo was often referred to as blue gold. It has been the foundation of textile export from India for centuries. But German chemical dyes invention in the late 19th century is the cause of decline in Indigo cultivation. The cultivation of Indigo was at its peak in the 19th century. It is estimated that in the year 1856, India produced about 19000 tons of Indigo, while after the Industrial Revolution in 1914, it was reduced to 1100 tons, due to which European Indigo planters of Champaran were forced to close their factories. Farmers also wanted to get rid of the thinkathia system (3/20) and indigo cultivation. Over time in this background, Gandhiji started the Champaran Satyagraha.